

Pick the item from your bucket list that's most exciting to you. We're going to figure out how to make it happen!

1. Estimate how much it will cost. This is the step that trips up a lot of people because they feel the need to be totally precise about the exact number. No! I want you to create a back-of-the-napkin number, then add 20 percent to it so you're not surprised. Like this: "My dream is to go to Italy for two weeks. I want to fly business class, which is probably \$3,000. Fancy hotels aren't a priority, so I could find a room for \$200/night. I really want to go to the Vatican, eat at a special restaurant, and visit Tuscany, which will all cost about \$500/day, so that's a total of around \$15,000. Add 20 percent for things I didn't anticipate, so that's \$18,000." Remember, your goal is not to be precise. It's to sketch out the rough prices so you can make your vision a reality. When in doubt, dream big!

2. Decide when you want to do it. Is this something you want to do three months from now? If so, you'll have to save \$6,000 per month. But what if you want to do it five years from now? Suddenly, you can take that amazing trip to Italy by saving \$300 per month.

3. For very large goals that are more than five years away, you can *invest* your money. When my wife and I did this exercise early on in our marriage, we decided we wanted to celebrate a ten-year wedding anniversary abroad with all our friends and family. We both picked a big number. Over that long time period, we saved and invested about half the amount needed, and investment returns made up the other half.

CREATE YOUR BUCKET LIST PLAN

Bucket Item:

Cost:

Timeline:

Plan: